

FREE STARTER

7 Days of Play First

Seven easy plays, a screen-spot plan and a tracker. Nothing to buy, nothing to ban.

 **Play Before Pixels**



Our screen spot

Same time, same place, same ending, every day. Never a prize, never a punishment.

When

Where

What

How it ends

How it ends, every day: a warning ("Two more minutes, then the tablet goes to sleep"), a clear ending (the episode ends or a timer rings) and a landing ("Now we go outside").

7-day tracker

1

Say-what-you-see walk

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

2

Stop and go dance

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

3

Tuck in the tablet

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

4

Basket surprise

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

5

Ready, set... go!

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

6

Color hunt

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

7

Blanket hideout

- o played
- o spot kept
- ☆ again!

Every play follows our published safety rules: a grown-up is always there; nothing small enough to fit through a toilet-paper tube for under-3s; no balloons for under-8s; water play always supervised. Parent education, not medical advice.

One a day, all with things you have



Say-what-you-see walk

From 12 months · No prep · No mess

Walk slowly through your home or down the street together. Stop wherever your child looks and put it into words: the door, the dog, the big truck. Wait a moment so your child can point, sound or talk back.

“You’re looking at the truck. Big truck. Beep, beep!”

2-minute version: Sit by a window for two minutes and name what goes by. **Safety:** Hold hands near roads and driveways. Keep little fingers away from outlets and anything hot.



Stop and go dance

From 15 months · No prep · No mess

Play a song and dance together. When you stop the music, everyone freezes. Hold the pause a little longer each time, then start again with a big “Go!”

“Ready... set... (wait) GO!”

2-minute version: Sit on the floor and do stop-and-go clapping. **Safety:** Clear a space away from sharp furniture corners and stairs.



Tuck in the tablet

From 18 months · No prep · No mess

When screen time ends, let your child switch the device off and “tuck it in” with a dish towel in its basket or drawer. Sing a tiny goodnight song together, then say what you’ll do next.

“Night-night, tablet. See you tomorrow! Now... let’s go PLAY!”

2-minute version: Just say, “Night-night, tablet,” and hold out your hand. **Safety:** Switch the device off first and never cover a device while it is charging. Grown-ups handle chargers and cords, and keep them out of reach of young children.



Basket surprise

From 12 months · 2-min prep · No mess

Cover the basket with a towel. Pull out one thing at a time, slowly, with a big “Ooh, what’s this?” Pause and let your child guess or reach. Play with it together for a moment, then pull out the next.

“What’s in here? ... (wait) ... A spoon! Bang, bang.”

2-minute version: Pull out one thing and ask, “What could this be?” Go with any answer. **Safety:** For under-3s, everything in the basket must be too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube. No cords or strings.



Ready, set... go!

From 12 months · No prep · No mess

Lean a book on a cushion to make a ramp. Hold the car at the top and say “Ready, set...” and wait. When your child looks, sounds or says “Go!”, let it roll. Cheer and do it again.

“Ready... set... (wait) GO!”

2-minute version: Play “ready, set, go” with tickles on the couch. **Safety:** For under-3s, toy cars and balls must be too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube.



Color hunt

From 18 months · No prep · No mess

Pick a color together and go looking for it outside: a red car, a red door, a red leaf. Point and name each one. Then pick a new color.

“Red! A red car. Red car going fast!”

2-minute version: Sit on the step and spot colors going past. **Safety:** Hold hands near roads. Check that nothing found outside goes into mouths, and dress for the weather.



Blanket hideout

From 18 months · 2-min prep · No mess

Drape a blanket over a table or two chairs to make a hideout. Bring in a flashlight or a couple of books. Let your child decide who is allowed in and what happens inside.

“Knock, knock! Can I come in? ... What’s the password?”

2-minute version: Lie under the blanket together and read one book with a flashlight. **Safety:** Use a light blanket, keep faces uncovered and stay nearby. No cords or strings tied to the den. Use a flashlight whose battery cover screws shut.

Five small talk moves to try this week

1. **Pause and wait.** Say a little, then stop. Count to five in your head. A look, a sound, a sign, a point or a word all count as an answer.
2. **Say what you see.** Put words to what your child is doing, right as it happens. No questions needed.
3. **Repeat and add one.** Say back what your child said or showed, and add one more word or idea.
4. **Offer a choice.** Hold up two options and wait. Reaching, pointing and looking all count.
5. **Follow their lead.** Let your child choose what to do and how. Join in and copy them.

Talk, sing and read in the language you know best. A sign, a point or a tap on a device counts as communicating.



Want the whole month?

30 Days of Back-and-Forth: 30 short lessons by email, 30 plays, plain words for 30 tricky moments and a full workbook. \$27, with a 30-day money-back guarantee. Written program; no videos, calls or coaching.

playbeforepixels.com/30-days